

Since then, revenue, Ebitda, and our share price have all taken off.” Maintaining that it is a very resilient company, he says with half a smile that “only the paranoid survive”. Meanwhile, net debt to Ebitda (the ability to repay debt assuming net debt and Ebitda don’t change) is down from seven times to zero. “In every way, the 2013–14 crisis taught us a lot,” he says. Today, he runs a strong ship that is embarking on a rather interesting journey. “We will be sitting down for a strategy session [soon],” says Pai. The move to position the company as a downstream value-added player will take time, but it is one that must be done, he says. As the world changes, so will Hindalco’s core aluminium business, and there is a huge opportunity to stand out. Pai clearly does not want to let that one pass.

The desire to position Hindalco as a downstream player is part of the larger game plan. “Upstream (mining and refining) is important, but growth and differentiation bring us closer to the consumer,” he says.

The acquisition of Novelis in 2007—it recently filed documents for a proposed initial public offering in the US—for \$6 billion gave Hindalco access to the can and beverage and automobile markets. The next step was

Super Large Companies		
SATISH PAI		
MD, HINDALCO INDUSTRIES		
Revenue from operations	FY23	2,23,202
	9MFY24	1,59,968
Profit before tax	FY23	13,241
	9MFY24	9,876
Profit after tax	FY23	10,097
	9MFY24	6,981
	FY23 RoE (%)	11.65
	Market Cap	1,16,462

● Data is on a consolidated basis; all figures in ₹ crore except RoE; 9MFY24: April-December 2023
 ● M-cap as of February 23, 2024
 ● **Data Source** BSE, ACE Equity

➤ Firm Footing

- ❶ The downstream market, people, and digital form the three pillars of Hindalco’s strategy
- ❷ The company sees a huge opportunity in downstream aluminium
- ❸ The acquisition of Novelis in 2007 gave Hindalco access to the can and automobile markets
- ❹ Expanding in the US will need to take the organic route following the buyout of Aleris
- ❺ Copper can be the next big story for Hindalco as it looks to expand aggressively
- ❻ This is especially so because of electrification, which will lead to an increase in copper requirement


The move to position the firm as a downstream value-added player will take time, but it is one that must be done, Pai feels. As the world changes, there is a huge opportunity for Hindalco to stand out